Burnt Hills-Ballston Lake Central Schools

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Confidential Report of Psychoeducational Evaluation

Student: Ila Taylor	**Date(s) of Evaluation:** 1/22, 1/23, 2/12/2026
Date of Birth: 11/21/2017	**Date of Report:** 2/24/2026
Age: 8 years, 2 months	**School**: Pashley Elementary School
Grade: Second Grade	**Examiner:** Carolyn Delaney, MS, CAS

Reason for Referral:

Ila Taylor was referred for this initial psychoeducational evaluation by the Committee on Special Education (CSE) following the completion of an Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) by Dr. Jennifer Mayette in November 2025. While a previous district evaluation in 2024 did not find Ila eligible for services at the time, the recent IEE identified significant deficits in phonological processing, executive functioning, and working memory, resulting in clinical diagnoses of ADHD (Combined Type), Dyslexia, and a Specific Learning Disorder in Written Expression. Despite receiving intensive Tier II and III interventions in both reading and math since first grade, Ila continues to demonstrate significant struggles in the classroom. Therefore, the school is conducting this evaluation to further explore her mathematics skills (not assessed through the IEE) and to confirm the recent neuropsychological findings. The purpose of this evaluation is to gain more information regarding Ila's educational and psychological needs, generate appropriate recommendations, and assist in determining initial eligibility for special education services. This evaluation is completed in conjunction with Speech/Language and Occupational Therapy evaluations.

Assessment Techniques & Procedures Used:

Review of Records
Social History
Behavioral Observations
Wechsler Individual Achievement Test, Fourth Edition (WIAT-4)

Developmental History:

The following information was obtained through a review of records along with a Social History form completed by Ila's mother, Saori Taylor. Ila resides with her mother, father, and twin sister (Reina; 8) in Glenville, NY. Ila is bilingual and speaks both Japanese and English in the home setting. Ila's mother reports that Ila is a "warm, kind, and outgoing child with a great sense of humor who loves making others laugh. She loves crafting, dives in with full focus when interested, and is confidently bilingual in Japanese and English". She describes her main areas of difficulty being her short attention span, is easily distracted, restless, has difficulty staying focused, frequently mouths objects, struggles with homework/tasks, takes excessive time,

needs repeated explanations, quickly loses motivation when difficult, becomes irritated or gives up, and becomes emotional or has tantrums over small things or when help is delayed.

According to the Social History form, Ila was born at full-term following a healthy twin pregnancy. Ila was breech, so both girls were delivered via cesarean section at 38 weeks and determined healthy at birth. Ila walked at 8 months, spoke her first words at one year, and met motor and speech/language milestones within normal limits thereafter. Ila has had a generally healthy childhood, with no major illnesses, allergies, or hospitalizations. There are no concerns with Ila's hearing, though there are some concerns with her vision. Ila navigates a typical routine for an eight-year-old child. After school, she enjoys playing with her sister and participating in gymnastics and wrestling. Since her first psychoeducational evaluation (2024), Ila has been diagnosed with Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder and Dyslexia (Dr. Jennifer Mayette).

Educational Background Information:

A review of educational records indicates that Ila attended preschool prior to attending Pashley. In Fall 2022, Ila began Kindergarten in Mrs. Mosall's classroom. Due to her young age and a planned long absence when her family would be traveling to Japan, it was determined that Ila and her sister would complete two years of Kindergarten. During her second year of Kindergarten, Ila progressed towards grade-level expectations in Reading, Writing, and Math. Due to being bilingual, Ila has received English as a New Language services to support her development as a learner. She has been receiving these services since she began at Pashley. Additionally, Ila received speech improvement services with the speech/language therapist to work on speech-sound production during her Kindergarten year.

In 2024, an initial psychoeducational evaluation was conducted for Ila to address parental concerns regarding her attention and focus and their subsequent impact on her academic development. At that time, Ila was in her second year of Kindergarten. Cognitive testing using the WPPSI-IV revealed that Ila's abilities were largely consistent and fell within the average range across the Verbal Comprehension, Visual Spatial, Fluid Reasoning, and Working Memory domains. Notably, she demonstrated a significant strength in processing speed, which was measured in the very superior range. Academic achievement testing through the KTEA-3 similarly showed performance within the average range for her age in reading, math, and written language. Behavioral ratings completed by her parents and teacher highlighted patterns of impulsivity and distractibility consistent with her referral concerns. Based on these results, Ila did not meet the criteria for special education services at that time, as her academic and cognitive profiles were within grade-level expectations.

Transitioning into first grade, the academic and behavioral demands increased significantly for Ila, revealing more pronounced challenges than those observed in Kindergarten. As the year progressed, it became evident that her foundational skills required more intensive intervention; she received Tier III Math support throughout the entire school year and was placed in Tier II Reading intervention during the second half of the year to address emerging literacy gaps. Parallel to these academic struggles, Ila's ability to maintain attention and focus notably declined as the curriculum became more rigorous and required greater sustained mental effort. This period of increased struggle led to further clinical investigation, resulting in a preliminary diagnosis of Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD). Ila's parents requested an IEE through the district to further explore her learning difficulties, though it took some time to find an agreed upon provider. During first grade, Ila also began outside counseling for support with self-regulation and tutoring services through the Huntington Learning Center.

In Fall 2025, a comprehensive Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) was completed by neuropsychologist Dr. Jennifer Mayette to further investigate Ila's persistent learning difficulties. Behavioral observations during this evaluation noted significant inattention, high activity levels, and sensory-seeking behaviors that interfered with task completion. The evaluation resulted in several formal diagnoses, including ADHD (Combined Type), a Specific Learning Disorder with impairment in Reading (Dyslexia), and a Specific Learning Disorder with impairment in Written Expression. While Ila's conceptual thinking remained in the low average range, her overall cognitive proficiency (specifically in sustained attention and working memory) was measured as below age-expectations. Dr. Mayette identified deficits in executive functioning, phonological awareness, and fine motor dexterity. The report concluded that Ila's previous average scores in Kindergarten may have masked underlying phonological processing deficits that became more apparent as academic demands increased in second grade, necessitating specialized instruction and significant support to access the curriculum.

Upon entering second grade, Ila qualified for Tier III Reading and Tier II Math. Mid-year data from the January benchmarking period indicates that despite these intensive supports, she requires Tier III intervention in both domains to address persistent gaps in her foundational skills. While Ila remains a hardworking, social, and creative student, the gap between her performance and grade-level expectations has become more pronounced, further highlighting the impact of her underlying learning disabilities and attentional challenges on her ability to make expected progress within the general education curriculum. Ila's teacher has noted that the learning challenges have also impacted Ila's self-esteem at times.

Ila's Reading and Math benchmark data for the current school year is below:

Reading:

September 2025								
DIBELS CWPM	**DIBEL Acc %**	**NWF/ CLS**	**NWF/W RC**	**HFW (124)**	**iReady Phonics**	**iReady Comp**	**F&P**	**Tier**
35	81	49	12	92	372	457	G	T3

January 2026								
NSW CLS	**NSW WRC**	**ORF**	**Acc**	**SW**	**iReady Phonics**	**iReady Comp**	**F&P**	**Qual Tier**
39	11	51	84	85	370	415	I	**T3**

Math:

September 2025									
	iReady Assessment						DIBELS		
Fall Tier	Diagnostic Scaled Score	Overall Score	Numbers & Operations	Algebra & Algebraic Thinking	Measurement & Data	Geometry	Computation	Concepts and Applications	Composite Score

Tier II	370	Mid - Late K	Mid - Late K	1	Mid - Late K	Mid - Late K	8	7	23
January 2026									
	iReady Assessment						DIBELS		
	Diagnostic Scaled Score	Overall Score	Numbers & Operations	Algebra & Algebraic Thinking	Measurement & Data	Geometry	Computation	Concepts and Applications	Composite Score
Tier III	386	K	K	1	1	K	10	8	28

Behavioral Observations:

Testing was completed across multiple sessions at Pashley Elementary School. Ila transitioned easily from her second grade classroom to the testing environment, greeting the examiner with a hug. She remained friendly, polite, and cooperative throughout the evaluation, maintaining a sweet personality and engaging in reciprocal conversation about her interests. While she attempted all items and persevered through challenging tasks without becoming overly frustrated, her presentation was characterized by significant impulsivity. Similar to previous evaluations, Ila exhibited a pattern of rushing through items, particularly during writing tasks, often attempting to provide a response before fully processing the instructions or options. She required frequent redirection to remain focused and consistent prompting to slow down and put forth her best effort. Despite these attentional challenges, Ila responded well to praise and was a pleasure to work with. She put forth a strong effort; therefore, the results of this evaluation are believed to be an accurate estimation of her current functioning and can be used to address the referral concerns.

Cognitive and Achievement Test Score Interpretations:

CATEGORY DESCRIPTORS	*STANDARD SCORE (SS)* RANGE*	*SCALED SCORE (ss)** RANGE*	*T-SCORE *** RANGE*	*PERCENTILE RANK (PR) RANGE*
Exceptional Strength, Very Well Developed, Very Superior	*≥ 130*	*16 - 19*	*≥ 70*	*≥ 98*
Above Average, Superior	*116 - 129*	*14 - 15*	*61 - 69*	*86 - 97*
(Low) Average (High)	*85 - 115*	*7 - 13*	*40 - 60*	*16 - 84*
Below Average, Borderline	*71 - 84*	*5 - 6*	*31 - 39*	*3 - 14*
Exceptional Weakness, Very Low, Impaired	*≤ 70*	*1 - 4*	*≤ 30*	*≤ 2*

**Mean 100; Standard Deviation 15 **mean 10; standard deviation 3 ***Mean 50; Standard Deviation 10*

[1]A percentile rank (PR) is provided for each index score to show the examinee's standing relative to other children the same age in the WISC-V normative sample. If the percentile rank for an examinee's Verbal Comprehension score is 58, for example, it means that the examinee performed as well as or better than approximately 58% of children his/her age.

[2]The scores obtained on the WISC-V reflect a student's true abilities combined with some degree of measurement error. Their true score is more accurately represented by a confidence interval (CI), which is a range of scores within which the true score is likely to

fall. Composite and scale scores are reported with 95% confidence intervals to ensure greater accuracy when interpreting the test scores. For each score reported there is 95% certainty that the examinee's true score falls within the listed range.

Review of Neuropsychological Evaluation

In November 2025, a comprehensive Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) was completed by Dr. Jennifer Mayette to further investigate Ila's learning difficulties. The evaluation confirmed significant deficits in phonological processing, executive functioning, and working memory. Consequently, Ila received formal diagnoses of **ADHD (Combined Type)**, a **Specific Learning Disorder with impairment in Reading (Dyslexia)**, and a **Specific Learning Disorder with impairment in Written Expression**.

The following tables summarize the most important data from this report:

Cognitive & Intellectual Functioning (WISC-V)			
Index/Scale	**Standard Score**	**Percentile Rank**	**Descriptive Category**
Full Scale IQ (FSIQ)	**77**	**6**	**Below Average**
General Ability Index (GAI)	87	19	Low Average
Cognitive Proficiency Index (CPI)	69	2	Very Low
Verbal Comprehension Index	92	30	Average
Visual Spatial Index	89	23	Low Average
Fluid Reasoning Index	85	16	Low Average
Working Memory Index	74	4	Below Average
Processing Speed Index	72	3	Below Average

Academic Achievement (KTEA-3)			
Subtest	**Standard Score**	**Percentile Rank**	**Descriptive Category**
Letter & Word Recognition	81	10	Below Average
Nonsense Word Decoding	87	19	Low Average
Silent Reading Fluency	86	18	Low Average
Reading Comprehension	80	9	Below Average
Word Recognition Fluency	106	66	Average

Spelling	85	16	Low Average
Written Expression	63	1	Very Low

Executive Functioning & Behavioral Ratings (BRIEF-2 / BASC-3)			
Scale/index	**Parent**	**Teacher**	**Classification**
Inhibit	Clinical Elevation	Clinical Elevation	Significant Concern
Working Memory	Clinical Elevation	Clinical Elevation	Significant Concern
Plan/Organize	Clinical Elevation	Clinical Elevation	Significant Concern
Attention Problems	74 (Clin. Sig.)	At-Risk	Significant Concern
Hyperactivity	At-Risk	71 (Clin. Sig.)	Significant Concern
Anxiety	Average	73 (Clin. Sig.)	Clinical Concern

Dr. Mayette reported *"Although she has many strengths, Ila shows some important areas of vulnerability that are impacting her educational success. These are as follows:*

- Attention and Executive Functioning: Ila has significant difficulty sustaining attention, organizing her work, initiating tasks, planning ahead, and self-monitoring her behavior. These challenges make it hard for her to follow instructions, complete assignments independently, and adapt to classroom routines.
- Processing Speed and Working Memory: Ila's paper and pencil processing speed is very low, requiring much more time than her peers to complete written tasks. She also struggles to hold information in mind while working, which affects her ability to follow multi-step directions and retain instructions.
- Memory: Ila experiences challenges with both immediate and delayed recall of verbal and visual information, making it difficult for her to learn and remember new material over time. Attention and executive functioning play a role; Ila is more successful with recall when cues and structure are provided.
- Phonological Awareness: Ila's ability to hear, isolate, remember, and manipulate speech sounds is below average, which affects her foundational reading skills and her ability to connect sounds with letters.

- Listening Comprehension: Despite receiving years of ENL (English as a New Language) instruction and being at an age when children typically absorb language rapidly, Ila's listening comprehension is very low. She has difficulty understanding spoken language, following directions, and answering questions about stories read aloud.
- Visual Perception, Integration, and Fine Motor Dexterity: Ila has below average skills in interpreting visual information, coordinating visual input with motor actions, and performing precise hand movements. These difficulties impact her ability to copy, draw, write, and engage with visual tasks in the classroom.

Current Evaluation Results:

Academic Assessment

The *Wechsler Individual Achievement Test, Fourth Edition (WIAT-4)* was utilized to assess Ila's academic functioning in the areas of reading, writing, math, and listening comprehension. Standard scores on this assessment are based on a mean of 100 and a standard deviation of 15 (average scores range from 85-115).

Reading

The Total Reading composite on the *WIAT-4* assesses overall reading skills. Ila achieved a score in the below average range in this domain. The composite consists of two subtests: Word Reading and Reading Comprehension. Ila's performance on the Word Reading subtest, which measured her decoding skills, was found to be in the below average range. Ila was successful with reading words such as **don't, shop, other, sky, goat,** and **foot**. Ila scored in the low average range when asked to read nonsense words. She had to rely entirely on her phonemic awareness skills to decode unfamiliar, made up words.

Ila was administered the Reading Comprehension subtest on the *WIAT-4* and achieved a score in the low average range. This task was untimed and assessed comprehension of Ila's independent reading skills, taught in the classroom and/or used in everyday life. The student reads words, sentences, and passages aloud or silently, and then answers open-ended questions. Ila read three increasingly complex passages. She correctly answered 3/11 literal comprehension questions (27%) and 5/8 inferential questions (63%). She correctly answered 7/11 comprehension questions from narrative texts (64%) and 1/8 questions from expository texts (13%).

On the Oral Reading Fluency subtest, the student reads two passages aloud. The subtest standard score is based on the average number of words read correctly per minute across the two passages. The student answers a comprehension question after each passage to encourage reading with comprehension, but comprehension does not factor into the score. Ila scored in the low average range on this subtest. On the first passage, she read 97 words in 137 seconds with 13 errors (12 incorrect words read; 1 addition). On the more challenging passage, she read 96 words in 122 seconds with 19 errors (19 incorrect words read; 0 addition). She answered the comprehension question correctly on 0 of the 2 passages.

Mathematics

The Wechsler Individual Achievement Test, Fourth Edition assesses two different areas of math skills for students in second grade: math problem-solving and numerical operations. Ila achieved an overall mathematics score in the average range.

Math Problem Solving assesses a student's ability to complete untimed math problems that are read to him/her. These problems are related to basic skills (counting, identifying shapes, etc.), everyday applications (time, money, word problems, etc.). Ila scored in the low average range for a second grade student. She demonstrated understanding of basic concepts, measuring an object, interpreting graphs and a calendar, addition and subtraction of objects, and completing number patterns. She had difficulty demonstrating proficiency in the following skills: identifying place value and identifying/using money.

The Numerical Operations subtest assesses a student's ability to solve written calculation problems. The student solves untimed written math problems using paper and pencil. Ila's performance was in the average range on this subtest, suggesting higher skills when the language of math is removed. She was able to accurately solve addition and subtraction with three-digit numbers. She was able to successfully regroup on ¾ items that required it. She attempted 4 single-digit multiplication problems but did not answer them correctly.

Written Language

The Alphabet Writing Fluency subtest is designed to measure how quickly the students can form the letters. They are given 60 seconds to write as many of the letters of the alphabet as they can. Ila was able to correctly write 21 of the 26 letters in one minute. There were some letters reversed and out of order. However, her performance was in the average range.

On the Sentence Building subtest of the WIAT-4, which requires the student to formulate a complete sentence using a target word in a specific context, Ila's overall performance fell within the average range. During this task, Ila demonstrated strong ideation, coming up with sentence concepts easily. However, her approach was characterized by a very rapid pace; she wrote quickly, which appeared to impact the mechanics of her output. While her score was within grade-level expectations, qualitative analysis of her work revealed two sentence fragments and instances where the context of the sentence did not align logically with the target word (e.g., when given the word "of," she wrote, "My aunt's name is of"). Notably, Ila exhibited a higher frequency of spelling errors when writing within the context of these sentences compared to her performance on the isolated spelling subtest. This included some words written backwards, such as writing "ma" for "am" suggesting that the added cognitive load of sentence formulation and her tendency to rush may exacerbate her difficulties with orthographic processing and self-monitoring.

The Spelling subtest measures written spelling of single words. The student hears letters then words within the context of a sentence, and then writes the letter or word. Ila scored in the average range on this subtest, suggesting her spelling skills are higher when in isolation. She correctly wrote the words increasing in difficulty up to **cake, cold, tall, mother, night,** and **began**.

Wechsler Individual Achievement Test, Fourth Edition (Composite Scores $M = 100$, $SD = 15$; Scaled Scores $M = 10$, $SD = 3$)

Index	Subtest	Composite/ Scaled Score	Percentile Rank	Descriptive Category
Total Reading		81	10	Below Average
Word Reading		82	12	Below Average
Pseudoword Decoding		85	16	Low Average
Reading Comprehension		85	16	Low Average
Oral Reading Fluency		85	16	Low Average
Mathematics		95	37	Average
Math Problem Solving		85	16	Low Average
Numerical Operations		107	68	Average
Written Expression		-	-	-
Alphabet Writing Fluency		99	47	Average
Spelling		102	55	Average
Sentence Building		94	34	Average

Summary and Recommendations:

Ila Taylor is a friendly, creative, and hardworking student in second grade at Pashley Elementary School. Ila is a bilingual student and receives ENL services. Ila was referred for this initial psychoeducational evaluation following an Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) in November 2025. Despite intensive Tier II and III interventions since first grade, Ila continues to struggle academically in the classroom, and the IEE identified deficits in phonological processing, executive functioning, and working memory. This current evaluation is being conducted to further explore her mathematics skills (not assessed in the IEE), confirm the neuropsychological findings, gather more information on her educational and psychological needs, and assist in determining her initial eligibility for special education services.

The Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) completed by Dr. Jennifer Mayette identifies a student with a solid foundation of conceptual and reasoning skills that is currently being masked by challenges in cognitive efficiency. Ila's core strengths lie in her verbal and visual-spatial abilities, which fall within the Low Average to Average range. These results indicate that she possesses the underlying cognitive ability to understand and engage with grade-level concepts. However, her learning profile is impacted by underdeveloped working memory and processing speed skills. Dr. Mayette found Ila to meet criteria for the following diagnoses: ADHD (Combined Type), Dyslexia, and Specific Learning Disorders in Reading and Written Expression. While Ila's "big picture" thinking is intact, she lacks the automaticity in phonological processing and executive control required to translate those ideas into consistent academic output. Additionally, as a bilingual student, Ila is managing a higher cognitive load when processing language, which may further tax her working memory in a fast-paced classroom environment.

Ila was also administered the WIAT-4 to further clarify her academic profile. In mathematics, Ila shows a clear relative strength in calculation and numerical operations; when she is able to focus on math facts without the interference of heavy linguistic demands or word problems, she performs within grade-level expectations. In literacy, however, Ila is still working to build the foundational decoding skills necessary for second grade. Her below average word reading and fluency scores suggest that she is relying on rote memory rather than phonetic

rules, which makes reading a labor-intensive task for her. In written language, Ila is a motivated student who generates ideas quickly. However, her rapid, sometimes impulsive pace (likely related to her ADHD) interferes with her ability to self-monitor. This leads to errors like sentence fragments and letter transpositions that do not reflect her true level of understanding. Ultimately, Ila is a capable learner who requires a structured, multisensory approach to literacy and specific executive functioning supports to ensure her academic performance accurately reflects her true skills.

Based on Ila's learning profile, the following suggestions are offered:

- It is recommended that the Committee on Special Education (CSE) discuss the results of this evaluation, in conjunction with classroom data, to determine the appropriate level of support for Ila.
- Reading
    - It is suggested that Ila's reading skills are continued to be addressed through a multisensory approach to learning to apply his phonics skills to decode familiar and unfamiliar words. She will continue to benefit from practice with letters/sounds and sight words to increase her fluency and automaticity.
    - Read aloud to Ila regularly to model fluent reading and expose her to a variety of vocabulary. Encourage Ila to also read aloud to others, promoting the development of fluency and expression, as well as her confidence as a reader.
- Mathematics
    - Visual Aids and Manipulatives: Ila should have consistent access to number lines, hundreds charts, and concrete manipulatives (cubes, counters) to support her calculation and number sense.
    - Checklists for Multi-Step Problems: Use visual "to-do" lists for multi-step word problems to help her stay on track and reduce the load on her working memory.
    - Extended Time: Allow extra time for math assessments to account for the need to double-check work due to impulsivity.
- Executive Functioning & ADHD Support
    - "Slow Down" Cues: Use a subtle visual cue (like a colored dot on her desk or a hand gesture) to remind Ila to pause and check her work before turning it in, addressing her tendency to rush.
    - Task Breakdown: Break large assignments into smaller, manageable "chunks." Provide a check-off list for each segment to give her a sense of progress and keep her focused.
    - Preferential Seating: Seat Ila near the point of instruction and away from high-traffic areas (sinks, pencil sharpeners) or windows to minimize environmental distractions.

    - Sensory Breaks: Incorporate scheduled "heavy work" or movement breaks (e.g., delivering a folder to the office, using a fidget) to help manage her high activity levels and sensory-seeking behaviors noted in the IEE.

- Testing & Classroom Accommodations
    - Offer extra time and check-ins for multi-step directions and consider providing both verbal and visual cues to support Ila's processing and retention of instructions.
    - Directions Clarified: Have Ila repeat directions back in her own words to ensure she has processed the instructions before beginning a task.
    - Extended Time: Provide 1.5x time on tests and quizzes
    - Testing in a Location with Minimal Distractions: Administer assessments in a location with reduced noise and visual distractions (may be within or outside the classroom).

Respectfully submitted,

Carolyn Delaney

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